WIRED TO WORK: YOUR BRAIN, YOUR PATH

Communication Skills Self-Assessment

Module 1 | Learner Worksheet

How are your communication skills? Do you know? Most of us only think about how we communicate after an awkward moment or a conversation that went really well. Let's take a few minutes to notice your patterns.

You stay you. These skills help the people around you see and hear the real you more clearly.

1. Read each statement and check the number that fits you today.
2. After each section, brainstorm how you could practice and write one goal.
3. Pick one or two sections to focus on first. You have time, so there's no need to work on everything at once.

1	2	3	4	5
Rarely	Once in a while	Sometimes	Often	Almost always

Your honest answer helps the most. A low number shows you where to practice.

1. Speaking Clearly and Confidently

How true is this for me today?	1	2	3	4	5
I get to my main point without adding more detail than my listener needs.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I share my ideas as statements instead of turning them into questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I speak in a clear, steady voice and finish my thoughts without trailing off.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Try this: Record a one minute voice memo about your day. Listen for filler words, trailing off and where your main point lands.

How I can practice	My goal

2. Listening and Responding

How true is this for me today?	1	2	3	4	5
I let other people finish speaking before I respond.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I acknowledge what the other person said before I share my own point.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I pause to think before I answer, including before I say yes or no.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Try this: The next time someone asks you for something, take a beat and say, "Thanks for asking. What are the details?"

How I can practice	My goal

3. Nonverbal Presence

How true is this for me today?	1	2	3	4	5
My posture shows confidence, with my head up and my shoulders back.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I show I'm listening by looking toward the speaker's eyes, or the bridge of their nose if that's more comfortable.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I stay present in conversations and keep my phone put away.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Try this: Before your next conversation, lift your head and roll your shoulders back. Practice a firm handshake with someone you trust.

How I can practice	My goal

4. Written Communication

How true is this for me today?	1	2	3	4	5
I adjust my tone for professional emails and messages, leaving out words and phrases like, “hey,” “lol” and “no worries.”	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
My emails include a clear ask or next step.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I write what I need without over-apologizing. I skip openers like “So sorry to bother you.”	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Try this: Before you hit send on your next email, read it once and ask yourself: can the reader tell what I need from them?

How I can practice	My goal

5. Group Settings and Feedback

How true is this for me today?	1	2	3	4	5
I share my ideas out loud in group conversations and meetings.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I notice cues from the group, like when someone has finished speaking or when the mood in the room shifts.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I stay open and curious when someone gives me feedback.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Try this: Set a small goal to share one idea out loud in your next group conversation.

How I can practice	My goal

Next step: Get a second view

Feedback is a gift when you’re ready for it. Pick someone you feel comfortable with, like a friend, family member, teacher or mentor, and share the Partner Version on the next page.

You could say: *“I’m working on my communication skills for my job search. Would you fill this out for me? Honest answers help me most.”*

When you get it back, compare the two. Where do your ratings match? Where do they differ?

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Communication Skills Feedback

Module 1 | Partner Version

Someone you know is taking Wired to Work, a course for young adults entering the workforce. They've asked for your view of how they communicate. Thank you for helping!

Check the number that fits what you've seen. Kind, honest answers help the most. If you haven't seen a skill in action, leave that row blank.

Feedback for: **From:** **Date:**

1	2	3	4	5
Rarely	Once in a while	Sometimes	Often	Almost always

1. Speaking Clearly and Confidently

How often do you see this?	1	2	3	4	5
They get to their main point without adding more detail than the listener needs.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
They share ideas as statements instead of turning them into questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
They speak in a clear, steady voice and finish their thoughts without trailing off.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What I've noticed *(an example helps)*

2. Listening and Responding

How often do you see this?	1	2	3	4	5
They let other people finish speaking before they respond.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
They acknowledge what the other person said before sharing their own point.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
They pause to think before they answer.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What I've noticed *(an example helps)*

3. Nonverbal Presence

How often do you see this?	1	2	3	4	5
Their posture shows confidence, with head up and shoulders back.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
They show they're listening by looking at the person who is speaking.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
They stay present in conversations and keep their phone put away.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What I've noticed *(an example helps)*

4. Written Communication

How often do you see this?	1	2	3	4	5
They adjust their tone for professional emails and messages.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Their emails and messages include a clear ask or next step.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
They write what they need without over-apologizing.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What I've noticed *(an example helps)*

5. Group Settings and Feedback

How often do you see this?	1	2	3	4	5
They share their ideas out loud in group conversations.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
They notice cues from the group, like when someone has finished speaking or when the mood in the room shifts.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
They stay open and curious when someone gives them feedback.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What I've noticed *(an example helps)*

Final Thoughts

A strength I see in how you communicate	One thing you could try